The Girl in the Picture

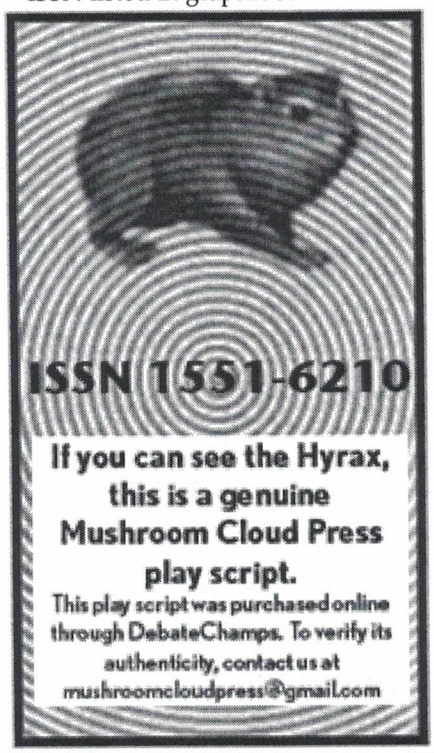
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SCENE TWO:

Layla and Jodi on Instant Messaging. Stage this as you will.

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22 has signed on.

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: hi

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22 : hello.

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: how friendly/unfriendly.

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22 : what do you prefer? howdy? hihi? hola?

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: you've said them all before

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22 : I like to mix it up. hello is acceptably cheery, I feel. does it need the exclamation mark to work?

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: I think the period conveys chilliness in IM. a hello there or hello, smiley face, or even just hey… even hello, no period, has a certain shortness, that, ironically, is not found in

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22 : well, let's start over. Hey hey, Layla Johnson! Smiley face. Or even, Grinning Face! How'sa by you?

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: hello.

JODI:
(beat) ChicFluxRock22: I see what you mean.
ChicFluxRock22: Hey, layla.

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: what?

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22: Merry Christmas!

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: Would you shut-

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22 Has signed off!

LAYLA:

Eowyn1R2RTA: Damn.

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22 is no longer available.

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: I know!

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22 is no longer available.

SCENE FOUR

Back online.

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA has signed on.
Eowyn1R2RTA: Hey. J. You there?

JODI:
Away Message from ChicFluxRock22: Despite all my rage I am just a rat in a cage. Despite all my rage I am just a rat in a cage. Despite all my rage I am just a rat in a… CAAAAGGGGE!!! Bullet With Butterfly Wings, The Smashing Pumpkins. Hellz yeah!

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: I gotta tell you, I've been listening to the album, both discs and iiiiiii just don't get it.
Eowyn1R2RTA; I mean, I get that he's angry. But I don't get the… point?
Eowyn1R2RTA: Especially not when I'm trying to write, cause… I mean. Hey. Enya works better for fantasy than rock. What can I say?
Eowyn1R2RTA: C'mon, J, where are ya? Come back to the land of the online dead! Weeeee missssss yoooouuuuu, weee misss-

JODI:
Away Message from ChicFluxRock22: Despite all my rage I am just a rat in a cage. Despite all my rage I am just a-

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: Yeah, yeah, I get it.
Eowyn1R2RTA: Meh.
Eowyn1R2RTA: You know what it is? Even the angriest these guys get, it's still about love, getting it or losing it or whatever-
Eowyn1R2RTA: and if it's not elves, I'm just not interested. No rock star's gonna kill himself over me, not unless I go bullemic.
Eowyn1R2RTA: Alright, I'm out. Fly, fly fly away-

JODI
ChicFluxRock22 is no longer away. ChicFluxRock22: Lays!

LAYLA:
Away message from Eowyn1R2RTA: Meh.

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22: Joe asked me out! I'm going to prom! Seven Mix Cds, Seven! AAAAAAAAA! Call me!
ChicFluxRock22 has signed off.

SCENE SIX

Back to the IM.

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22: Hey, you there?

LAYLA:
Away Message from Eowyn1R2RTA: Aragorn: Are you frightened? Frodo: Yes! Aragorn: Not frightened enough! What, exactly was Frodo supposed to say? Yes, I'm crapping my boots? Face with tounge stinking out.

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22: Why'd you leave?
ChicFluxRock22: Hello??
(beat)
ChicFluxRock22: Layla
ChicFluxRock22: you got my on my knees…
ChicFluxRock22: : *laayyylllaaaaa*...
ChicFluxRock22: I had a great time, hope u did too
(turns halfway)
ChicFluxRock22: oh, hey some great person gave me a camera, and then I took a picture of me and this great person
ChicFluxRock22: but then she left…
ChicFluxRock22: so I couldn't show her the picture
ChicFluxRock22: so.
ChicFluxRock22 wants to send a file: "jlconcert03.jpg."
ChicFluxRock22: accept.
ChicFluxRock22: accept the file, biznitch!
ChicFluxRock22: oh crap, I think I just deleted them off the camera

SCENE TEN:

Over IM. Late.

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22: Hi.

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: Hello. (beat)

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22: I just want to say- backspace backspace backspace. It was really messed up when- backspace backspace backspace- you're still-

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: It's no big thing. I'm not going to slit my wrists or kill your mom. I wish you and Joe luck. So, luck.

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22: For what, our honeymoon????
ChicFluxRock22: I still want to be friends.

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: Well, it's too late to say you're sorry.

JODI:
ChicfluxRock22: what did I do?? You're the one that-

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: How would I know, why should I care?
Eowyn1R2RTA: Please don't bother trying to find her.
Eowyn1R2RTA: She's not there.

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22: ...right.
ChicFluxRock22: You know the thing is, Layla, I have other friends.
ChicFluxRock22: And I know you d-backspacebackspacebackspace

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: I know.
Eowyn1R2RTA: And I have other friends.
Eowyn1R2RTA: Elves, Orcs and Starships. Oh my.

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22: ....the other girls are nicer to me now
ChicFluxRock22: but they're dumb, they're just so dumb
ChicFluxRock22: I miss you. I miss talking to you.

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: So talk. You're not on my block list.

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22: I N P E R S O N.

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: So call.

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22: do you want to come over or not?

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: That position-backspace. I don't work part- backspace backspace.
Eowyn1R2RTA: No.

JODI:
ChicFluxRock22: ....
ChicFluxRock22: So, Luck.

User ChicFluxRock22 is not available.

LAYLA:
Eowyn1R2RTA: Luck.

JODI:
User ChicFluxRock22 is-

Layla hits her power switch. Blackout..